

Emergency Triage Protocol

Purpose of Triage

- Triage is the process of quickly sorting patients by the severity of their condition so the sickest patients are treated first.
- Shifa International Hospitals uses a 4-level triage system based on the Emergency Severity Index (ESI) model.

Triage Levels

- Level 1 – Critical: immediate life threat (e.g., cardiac arrest, severe airway obstruction). Seen immediately, no waiting.
- Level 2 – Emergent: high risk situation, unstable vitals, or severe pain (e.g., chest pain, stroke symptoms). Seen within 10 minutes.
- Level 3 – Urgent: stable but needs several resources (e.g., moderate abdominal pain, fractures). Seen within 30-60 minutes.
- Level 4 – Non-urgent: minor complaints needing one resource or less (e.g., minor cuts, cold symptoms). Seen within 60-120 minutes.

Triage Nurse Responsibilities

- Record chief complaint, vital signs, allergies, and current medications.
- Assign the ESI level and communicate it clearly to the receiving team using the color-coded triage board (Red, Orange, Yellow, Green).
- Re-triage any patient whose condition changes while waiting.

Special Situations

- Pediatric, obstetric, and psychiatric emergencies follow the same 4-level system but are flagged for the relevant on-call specialist immediately after triage.
- Mass casualty events trigger the hospital's Emergency Preparedness Plan, which temporarily overrides normal triage staffing ratios.